

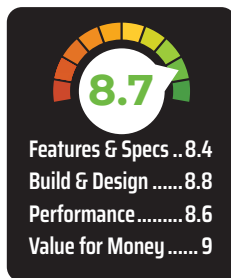
Sony WH-1000XM6

Sony's most complete headphones yet

The Sony WH-1000XM6 (Mark 6) are the company's flagship headphones for 2025, and they feel every bit the part. Rather than reinventing the wheel, Sony has built on what already worked brilliantly with the WH-1000XM5, polishing the experience with thoughtful, real-world improvements. Under the hood, a new QN3 processor is working alongside a 12-microphone array to deliver smarter, more adaptive noise cancellation and clearer call quality, even in noisy spaces. Sony's also added support for 360 Reality Audio Upmix for Cinema, which gives your favourite films and shows a more immersive soundstage. Then there's the all-new 30mm driver unit, made with a carbon fibre composite dome, which tightens up the audio response for cleaner highs and more precise detail. The tuning, co-crafted with mastering engineers from Sterling Sound, Battery Studios, and Coast Mastering, aims for what Sony boldly calls 'studio-level accuracy.'

But the first thing you'll actually notice doesn't require any tech spec sheet. The Sony XM6 finally folds again! Yes, the foldable hinge is back, and the case is smaller and sleeker, complete with a new magnetic latch that feels satisfyingly premium. It's a small change, but one that makes a big difference when you're on the move.

So, while it's clear that the design tweaks make a difference in everyday use, the bigger question is whether Sony's refinements in sound, ANC, and overall performance justify the higher price tag. The Sony WH-1000XM6 has launched in India at Rs 5,000 more than the XM5, and after spending some time with them, here's what I've found.



The Sony WH-1000XM6 offers strong noise cancellation, clear calls, and a lighter, more travel-friendly design. The sound is warm and full, and the battery easily lasts through long use. A few smart features remain a bit inconsistent, and the lack of water resist-

ance is a minor miss, but overall, the XM6 feels thoroughly refined. It strikes the right balance between comfort, performance, and dependability, making it one of the most practical and desirable wireless headphones you can buy today.

UNBOXING AND DESIGN

Like we said in our first impressions, the key difference from the XM5 is the XM6's new foldable hinge. It lets the headphones pack down smaller, and the metal reinforcement adds durability. Sony also includes a redesigned case with a magnetic latch for opening and closing. It's easy to open, but fitting the headphones inside takes a bit of effort.

You have to align them properly for the latch to snap shut.

Out of the case, the headphones look gorgeous. Our review unit is the Platinum Silver variant, and you can pick it in Black and Midnight Blue colours, too.

The XM6 keeps the familiar Sony look but introduces small changes that make it easier to wear for longer stretches. The headband is flatter and sits closer to the head, which reduces pressure points. The new vegan leather ear pads seal better around the ears, improving passive isolation without feeling stiff. Comfort is generally solid, though the clamp can feel warm and slightly sweaty in Delhi summers.

Sony now allows users to replace the ear pads. It is not as simple as pulling them off, so watching a quick YouTube guide beforehand is recommended.

At 254g, the Sony XM6 is much lighter than the 386g AirPods Max. The polycarbonate build helps keep the weight down, and you can feel the difference during long listening sessions. There is still no IP rating, so be careful around rain and workouts. Also, the headphones can slip more easily on long hair, especially if worn loosely.

In terms of controls and ports, the left earcup houses six microphones, a 3.5mm headphone jack, a power button, and a customisable button that switches between ANC and ambient sound, or can be reassigned to other functions. The right earcup features additional microphones, a USB-C port, and responsive touch controls for playback and volume adjustments.

Although the Sony XM6 is primarily a wireless pair, the included 3.5mm cable comes in handy for low-latency or high-resolution wired listening, and it's a reliable backup when the battery runs out. In the box, you also get a USB-A to USB-C charging cable, a 1.2m aux cable, and a quick start guide. Alongside the physical buttons, the touch gestures work smoothly for managing music, calls, and volume without needing to reach for your phone.